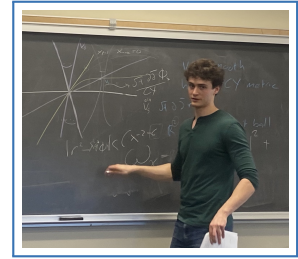


Benjy Firester

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Education

- 2023– **Ph.D. in Mathematics**, *MIT*, Levinson fellow, Mathworks fellow 2023–2025
Geometric Analysis & Complex Geometry advised by [Toby Colding](#) and [Tristan Collins](#)
Levinson Fellowship 2024, Mathworks Fellowship 2023–2025
- 2023 **A.B. & A.M. in Mathematics**, *Harvard University*, *Summa Cum Laude*
Honors thesis advised by [Curt McMullen](#)

Research & Expository

- [1] Tristan C. Collins, Benjy Firester, and Freid Tong. Homogeneous optimal transport maps between oblique cones. *arXiv:2511.01692*, 2025.
- [2] Tristan C. Collins and Benjy Firester. On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations. *arXiv:2508.05551*, 2025.
- [3] Benjy Firester, Raphael Tsiamis, and Yipeng Wang. Uniqueness of cylindrical tangent cones $C_{p,q} \times \mathbb{R}$. *arXiv:2507.22373*, 2025.
- [4] Benjy Firester and Raphael Tsiamis. Cohomogeneity two Ricci solitons with sub-Euclidean volume. *Journal of Geometric Analysis*, 35(407), 2025.
- [5] Benjy Firester. Mostow rigidity and hyperbolic 3-manifolds, 2023. benjyjf.com/thesis.pdf.
- [6] Benjy Firester. Complete Calabi–Yau metrics from smoothing Calabi–Yau complete intersections. *Geometriae Dedicata*, 218(2):46, Feb 2024.
- [7] L. Becker, S. Elliott, B. Firester, S. Gonen Cohen, Michal Pnueli, and Vered Rom-Kedar. *Impact Hamiltonian systems and polygonal billiards*, page 29–66. Mathematical Sciences Research Institute Publications. Cambridge University Press, 2024.

Awards

- 2023 **Mumford Prize**, “Most promising senior concentrator in mathematics”
math.harvard.edu/undergraduate-prizes-and-awards-2022-2023
- 2023 **Friends Prize**, *Top two theses present to The Friends of the Harvard Math Department*
Presented senior thesis [5] see: math.harvard.edu/event/special-lecture... and interviewed in the [2023 Harvard Math Newsletter](#)
- 2023 **Hoopes Prize**, \$5,000
Awarded for my senior thesis [5] see: prizes.fas.harvard.edu/.../2022-2023_hoopes...
- 2022 **Phi Beta Kappa**, *Member of Senior 48*
National academic honor society see: thecrimson.com/article/2022/11/15/harvard-pbk-senior-48

- 2022 **Goldwater Scholar, \$7,500**
For my work [6] see: goldwaterscholarship.gov/2022-goldwater-scholars...
- 2022 **Herchel-Smith Fellow, "A competitive and generous award" for Harvard research**
Research funding for [5] see: uraf.harvard.edu/.../herchel-smith-summer-fellowship
- 2022 **PRISE Fellow, Harvard summer research community for science**
Research funding for [5] see: uraf.harvard.edu/uraf-opportunities/prise
- 2022 **John Harvard Scholar, Harvard College Scholar (2019)**
[Dean's list](#)
- 2018 **Winner of Regeneron Science Talent Search, \$250,000**
Formerly Westinghouse/Intel STS see: societyforscience.org/...regeneron-science-talent-search-2018
- 2017 **Davidson Fellow, \$25,000**
Scientific scholarship winner from the Davidson Institute see: davidsongifted.org/.../2017-fellows

Presentations

- 11/18/2025 **Informal Geometric Analysis Seminar, University of Maryland**
Presented On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations [2] see: <https://www.math.umd.edu/~tdarvas/IGA.html>
- 11/07/2025 **Geometric Analysis Seminar, Columbia University**
Presented On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations [2] Click: "[Geometric Analysis Seminar](#)" Tab
- 9/25/2025 **Workshop on Geometry and PDEs, University of Copenhagen (GeoTop)**
Presented On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations [2] see: math.ku.dk/.../workshop_on_geometry_and_pdes_sep_2025
- 6/11/2025 **Workshop on Topics in Differential Geometry, Brown University**
Presented On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations [2] see: brown.edu/christine-breiner-brown/workshop-2025
- 5/02/2025 **Pure math graduate student seminar (PUMAGRASS), MIT**
Presented On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations [2] see: <https://math.mit.edu/pumagrass/>
- 4/22/2025 **Geometric Analysis Seminar, Rutgers University**
Presented On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations [2] see: math.rutgers.edu/.../free-boundary-monge-ampere-and-optimal-transport-equations
- 4/19/2025 **AMS New England Grad Student Conference (PDE), Brown University**
Presented On a general class of free boundary Monge-Ampère equations [2] see: sites.google.com/brown.edu/amsgradconference/talks
- 1/22/2025 **Calculus of Variations and PDE's in Geometric Analysis, Sapienza Università di Roma**
Poster presentation of Cohomogeneity two Ricci solitons with sub-Euclidean volume [4] see: sites.google.com/uniroma1.it/cvga2025
- 1/16/2025 **Geometry and Topology Seminar, Hebrew University**
Presented Cohomogeneity two Ricci solitons with sub-Euclidean volume [4] see: mathematics.huji.ac.il/~firester...cohomogeneity-two-ricci-solitons...
- 1/14/2025 **PDE and Applied Mathematics Seminar, Technion University**
Presented Cohomogeneity two Ricci solitons with sub-Euclidean volume [4]
- 7/8/2024 **Seminario de geometría, University of Granada**
Presented Cohomogeneity two Ricci solitons with sub-Euclidean volume [4] see: wpd.ugr.es/.../collapsing-cohomogeneity-two-ricci-solitons/

- 7/8/2024 **Seminario de geometría**, *University of Granada*
Presented Cohomogeneity two Ricci solitons with sub-Euclidean volume [4] see: wpd.ugr.es/.../collapsing-cohomogeneity-two-ricci-solitons/
- 4/1/2023 **Harvard Special Lecture for Friends Prize Recipient**, *Harvard University*
Presented senior thesis [5] see: math.harvard.edu/event/special-lecture...
- 3/29/2023 **Harvard Math Table**, *Harvard University*
Non-compact Calabi-Yau manifolds [6] see: sites.google.com/.../mathtable...
- 2/23/2023 **Stanford Special Geometry Seminar**, *Stanford University*
Complete CY metrics from smoothing CY complete intersections
see: mathematics.stanford.edu/...geometry-seminar-complete-calabi-yau-metrics...
- 1/5/2023 **Joint Mathematics Meeting**, *AMS Contributed Papers in Geometry*
Complete CY metrics from smoothing CY complete intersections
see: meetings.ams.org/math/jmm2023/meetingapp.cgi/Paper/19585
- 11/18/2022 **RTG Partial Differential Equations on Manifolds**, *Undergraduate Analysis and PDE Seminar*, with **T. C. Collins**
Complete CY metrics from smoothing CY complete intersections
see: tarheels.live/waves/activities/undergraduate-online-seminar-fall-2022

Teaching

- Spring 2023 **Harvard Math 123**, *Course Assistant*, taught by **Curt McMullen**
Rings, Fields, Galois theory
- Fall 2022 **Harvard Math 101**, *Course Assistant*, taught by **Curt McMullen**
Sets, Groups, and Knots
- Spring 2022 **Harvard Math 123**, *Course Assistant*, taught by **Mark Kisin**
Rings, Fields, Galois theory
- Fall 2021 **Harvard Math 114**, *Course Assistant*, taught by **Dennis Gaitsgory**
Measure, Integration, Banach spaces, Duality, and Fourier analysis
- Spring 2020 **Harvard Math 55b**, *Course Assistant*, taught by **Joe Harris**
Topology and Real/Complex analysis
- Fall 2019 **Harvard Math 55a**, *Course Assistant*, taught by **Joe Harris**
Group theory, Linear algebra, Representation theory

Service

- 2025 **Co-organizer**, *MIT Geometric Analysis Reading group*
<https://benjyjf.com/GeometricAnalysisReadingGroup/>
- 2025 **UROP mentor**, *MIT Math department*
Graduate mentor for prestigious Undergraduate Research Opportunity urop.mit.edu/
- 2023-2024 **PRIMES mentor**, *MIT Math department*
Graduate mentor for prestigious high school mathematics research program see: <https://math.mit.edu/research/highschool/primes/program/>
- 2024– **Referee**
Acta Mathematica, Journal of Differential Geometry
- 2023– **GUMMI mentor**, *MIT Math department*
Graduate mentor for MIT mathematics undergraduates interested in graduate school see: <https://math.mit.edu/gummi/>

- 2023– **Non-resident tutor, Winthrop House**
Advisor for undergraduates specializing in STEM and pre-career related disciplines
winthrop.harvard.edu/people/benjoy-firester
- 2023 **Math community undergraduate mentor for GIIM, Harvard GIIM**
Gender Inclusivity In Mathematics see: harvardgiim.org
- 2019–2022 **Volunteer at JF&CS**
Volunteered helping Holocaust survivors at the [Jewish Family and Children's Service](#)

Affiliations

- 2023– **MIT Mathematics Department, PhD Student**
Geometric Analysis & Complex Geometry
- 2018–2023 **Harvard Mathematics Department, Bachelors (Summa Cum Laude) and Masters, Course Assistant**
Advised by Curt McMullen, Joe Harris, Cliff Taubes, Peter Kronheimer
- 2019–2023 **The Harvard Advocate, Technology editor 2019–2020**
theharvardadvocate.com/
- 2019–2023 **The Harvard Political Review, Technology board member**
harvardpolitics.com/
- 2019–2022 **MIT Mathematics Department, Research with Tristan Collins**
Funded by [HCRP](#)
- 2020 **D. E. Shaw, Systematic Equities**
Quantitative research intern
- 2019 **Microsoft, Excel Alpha Team**
Software engineering intern
- 2018 **Weizmann Institute, Advised by Vered Rom-Kedar**
International Summer Science Institute research program ([ISSI](#))
- 2012–2018 **Hunter College High School**
- 2017 **Rockefeller University, Krueger Group**
Summer Science Research Program ([SSRP](#))
- 2015–2016 **The Agricultural Research Organization (Volcani), Research advised by Lior Blank and Dani Shtienberg**

Languages

- Hebrew **Advanced**
Citation in Modern Hebrew from Harvard
- Spanish **Proficient**

Other Scientific Papers and Presentations

- 2020 **The MIT Undergraduate Journal of Economics, with Andrew Komo**
[Resource allocation with externalities](#) second best paper award
- 2020 **Journal of Biomedical Optics, Gareau et al.**
[Deep learning-level melanoma detection by interpretable machine learning and imaging biomarker cues](#)

- 2018 **Plant Pathology**, with *Dani Shtienberg & Lior Blank*
[Modelling the spatiotemporal dynamics of Phytophthora infestans at a regional scale](#)
doi:10.1111/ppa.12860
- 2018 **The Concord Review**, *Volume 28, No. 3*, Emerson Prize
Mail-Order
- 2017 **Euroblight**, *International conference*
Presentation by Lior Blank on our paper in Plant Pathology see: [Euroblight programme](#)